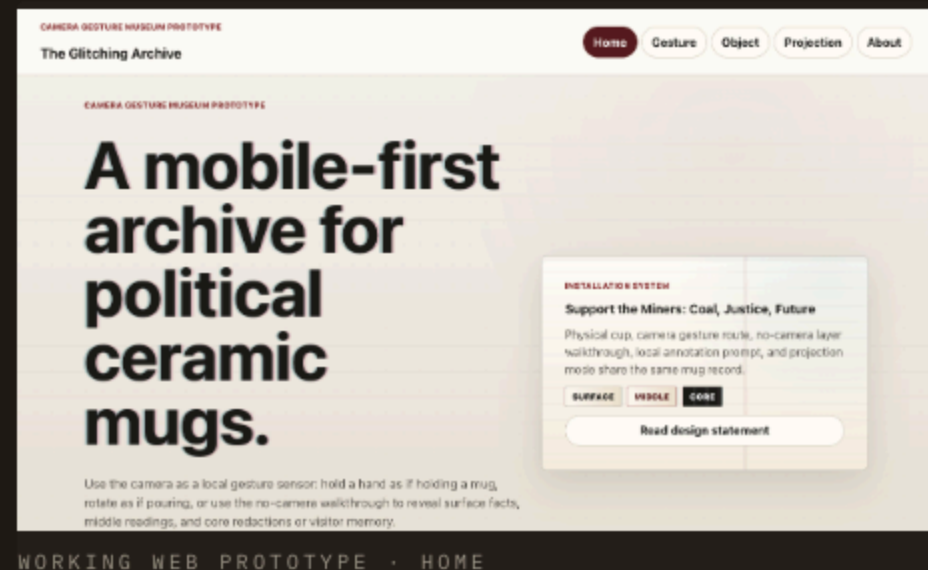


MOBILE-FIRST · GESTURE-BASED ARCHIVE

The Glitching Archive: Warmth & Echoes

A mobile-first, gesture-based archive for political ceramic mugs at V&A East Storehouse.

POLITICAL CERAMIC MUGS AS VESSELS OF PUBLIC MEMORY



TITLE

THREE QUESTIONS

How might a stored object become emotionally accessible?

HMW 01

Frame

How do museum storage, catalogue language, and label systems shape what a political mug is allowed to mean?

BRIEF ALIGNMENT · OBJECT GROUP, FRAMING ANALYSIS, DIGITAL DISPLAY, ETHICS

HMW 02

Layer

How can visible facts, speculative readings, and withheld memories sit together without becoming false certainty?

HMW 03

Invite

How can visitors question and contribute to object narratives without turning sensitive histories into a vote?

HMW

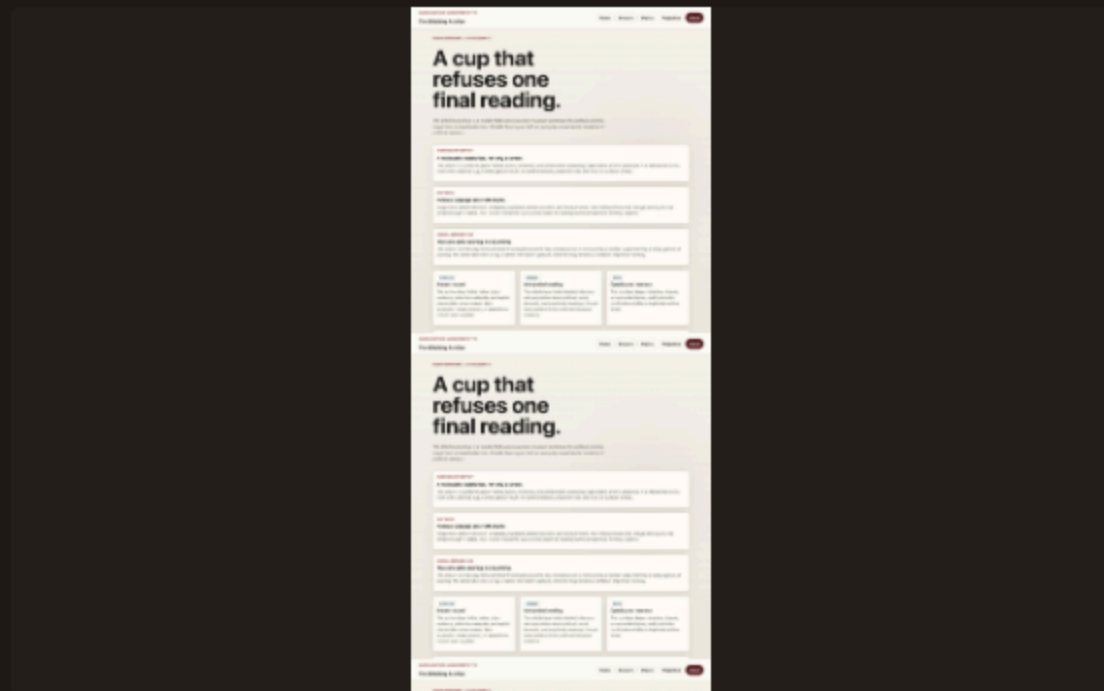
PHYSICAL ACCESS ≠ EMOTIONAL ACCESS

Open storage still needs interpretive access.

Storehouse access can make objects visible, but visibility alone does not recover use, domestic handling, political feeling, or contested memory.

AUDIENCE · V&A EAST VISITORS, STUDENTS, LOCAL COMMUNITIES, POLITICAL/DESIGN HISTORY LEARNERS

CONTEXT



1981-1989 • SELECTION FRAME

Three mugs map public politics into domestic handling.

RECORD 01 • VERIFICATION NEEDED

Support the Miners

Coal, justice, future. Selected for labour conflict, solidarity, and everyday political display.

RECORD 02 • VERIFICATION NEEDED

Labour Red Rose

Party image enters the kitchen. Selected for domestic political signalling and affiliation.

RECORD 03 • VERIFICATION NEEDED

People's March for Jobs

A route held in a cup. Selected for unemployment, public protest, and personal memory.

Final submission needs checked object name, accession number, museum record, date, image source, collection rights, and political context for each mug.

OBJECT METADATA IS DELIBERATELY MARKED UNTIL VERIFIED AGAINST MUSEUM RECORDS

OBJECT GROUP

CURRENT FRAMING ANALYSIS

Catalogue records preserve material facts, but flatten lived use.

What the museum record can hold

OBJECT NAME · DATE · MATERIAL · MAKER · ACCESSION ·
STORAGE LOCATION · VISIBLE INSCRIPTION

What the interface asks back

WHO USED IT? WHAT CONFLICT DOES IT INDEX? WHICH
MEMORIES ARE MISSING, CONTESTED, OR WITHHELD?

EVIDENCE GAP TO FILL BEFORE FINAL SUBMISSION
FRAMING CLAIM · MATERIAL ACCESS DOES NOT EQUAL NARRATIVE ACCESS

ANALYSIS

CUP AS VESSEL

The cup holds more than liquid.

PHYSICAL VOLUME

Tea, ceramic surface, handle, printed slogans, maker, date, damage, catalogue metadata.

EMOTIONAL VOLUME

Political attachment, domestic routine, labour memory, family disagreement, withheld harm, local testimony.

NOT A TRUTH LADDER

Surface, Middle, and Core mark evidence status.

SURFACE

Catalogue Fact

Visible metadata, material evidence, object text, catalogue gaps.

MIDDLE

Inference

Political, social, domestic, and emotional readings labelled as interpretation.

CORE

Consent

Oral memory, redacted fragments, withheld names, material requiring evidence or permission.

The deeper layer is not more true. It is more sensitive and needs clearer evidence boundaries.

LABELS • FACT / INFERENCE / SPECULATION / VISITOR MEMORY / REDACTED / NEEDS CONSENT

LAYER LOGIC

The prototype turns browsing into a bodily gesture.

VISITOR FLOW

01

Scan

Enter the mobile web companion from a label, QR, or display prompt.

02

Choose

Select a political mug and inspect verified object metadata.

03

Pour

Use camera gesture or slider fallback to move through layers.

04

Read

Follow fact, inference, redaction, and contribution labels.

05

Contribute

Leave a labelled question, memory, dispute, or counter-reading.

CAMERA OR SLIDER → POUR VALUE → ARCHIVE LAYER

Camera is used as local gesture sensing, not historical authority.

SYSTEM CHAIN

Input

Camera permission or slider

ACCESS AND PRIVACY ARE PART OF THE INTERACTION MODEL

Mapping

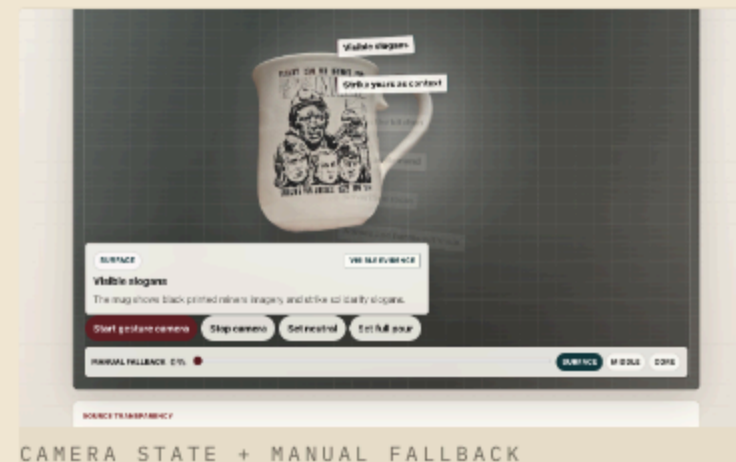
Hand rotation becomes a pour

Layer

Value shifts Surface, Middle,

Output

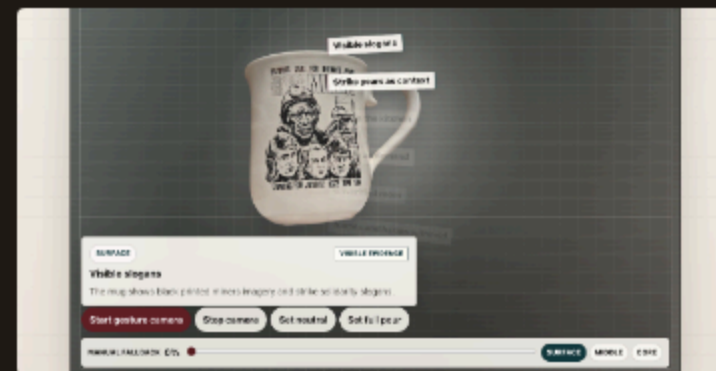
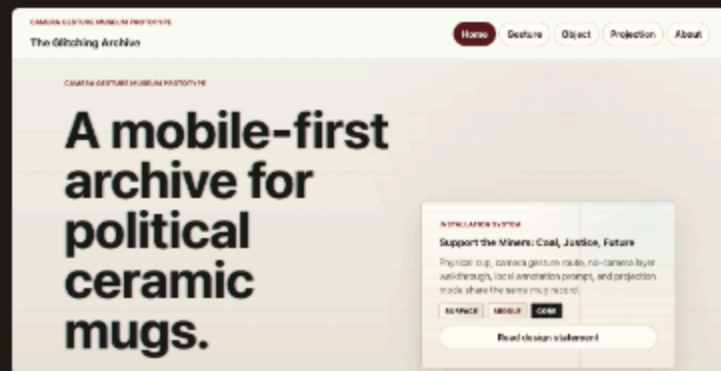
Mug tilt, fragments, labels,



SYSTEM LOGIC

MOBILE-FIRST WEB PROTOTYPE

Working screens already demonstrate the archive logic.



The design outcome is not only an idea deck: it is a phone-based route, no-camera route, layer logic, local contribution loop, and projection mode.

NOT HISTORIAN · NOT PROOF

AI helps produce questions, not historical truth.

AI-assisted material can suggest associations, compare fragments, and surface uncertainty, but it must be labelled and reviewed against sources.

AI IS A SUPPORT SYSTEM FOR SPECULATION AND MARKING UNCERTAINTY



AI ROLE

REDACTION IS NOT FAILURE

Some stories should remain withheld until evidence and consent exist.

PRIVACY

No Upload

Camera input is local; no visitor video is recorded or uploaded.

ACCESS

Fallback

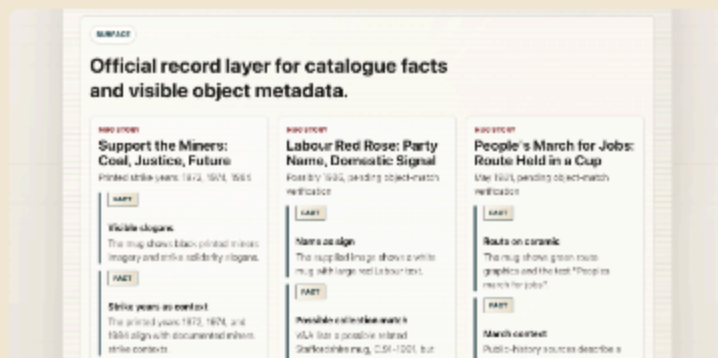
No-camera walkthrough and slider preserve access for different bodies, devices, and comfort levels.

MODERATION

Review

Visitor contributions are stored as labelled public responses, reviewed or contextualised before projection.

The phone interaction becomes a shared museum display.



RETRO ARCHIVE · STATIC · DOCUMENTARY FRAGMENT

Glitch appears where certainty breaks.

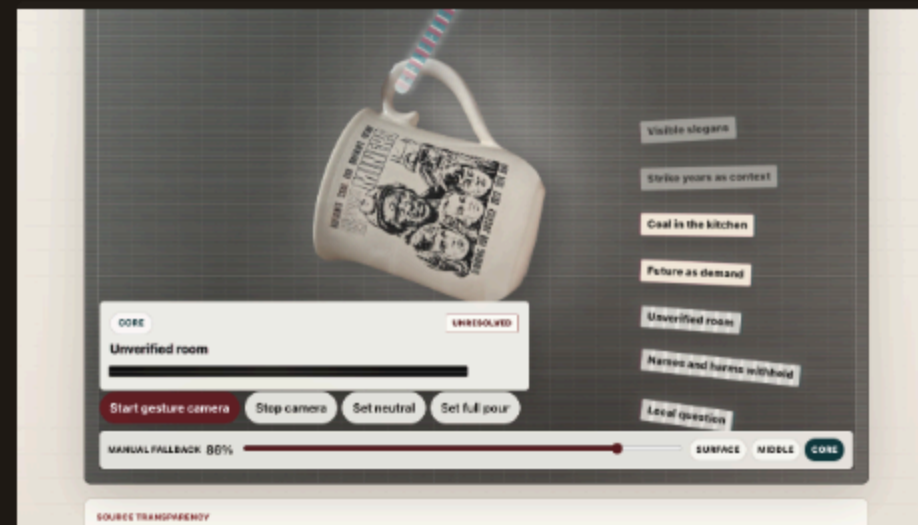
The visual system keeps the prototype deck's calm editorial structure, then uses glitch language only around absence, redaction, speculation, and contested fragments.

IDENTITY RULES

Archive**Glitch****Sound**

VISUAL STYLE KEEPS PROTOTYPE POLISH AND USES GLITCH AS EVIDENCE-BOUNDARY LANGUAGE

IDENTITY



CORE STATE · GLITCH AS ETHICAL MARKER

DESIGN AND CRITICAL ANCHORS

The project sits between interface precedent and archive theory.

DESIGN PRECEDENT

The Enemy

Karim Ben Khelifa's interactive journalism project; empathy through spatial encounter.

READING

Critical Fabulation

Saidiya Hartman, "Venus in Two Acts" (2008): writing with and against archival absence.

FORMAL CITATIONS SHOULD BE CHECKED AND EXPANDED BEFORE FINAL ACADEMIC SUBMISSION

DESIGN PRECEDENT

Manual of Errors

Architecture of uncertainty; exact bibliographic details to verify before submission.

READING

Museum Interface

Add one verified museum/digital archive reading to strengthen public-display framing.

REFERENCES

The cup does not reveal one stable truth.

The Glitching Archive uses political ceramic mugs from V&A East Storehouse as everyday vessels of public memory. Through a mobile-first pouring interaction, visitors move between catalogue facts, speculative interpretation, redacted histories, and local contribution. The project does not claim to recover one hidden truth. Instead, it makes the archive's cracks, absences, and evidence boundaries visible, turning physical access into emotional and critical access.